COMPARISON · MATRIX · STRUCTURE

matrix-grid

Two ordered axes as an N×M chart-family grid — each cell marks a position (filled / reachable / not applicable), colored by its row's category from the theme's chart palette.

Your level is a cell, not a rung.

Your title is the diagonal — the same verb at a wider reach is a different level.

WIDER REACH ▶

▲ DEEPER COGNITION

	SELF	TEAM	ORG	FIELD
Create				Distinguished
Evaluate			Principal	
Analyze			Staff	
Apply		Senior		
Understand	Mid			
Remember	Junior			

● Your level · ○ *where you can operate when called for* — illustrative, placements vary by company.

Six categories by five columns is the grid's practical ceiling.

WIDER REACH ▶

DEEPER COGNITION ▲

	SELF	PAIR	TEAM	ORG	FIELD
Vision					Chief
Strategy				VP	
Execution			Director		
Delivery		Manager			
Craft	Senior				
Basics	Associate				

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WIDER REACH ▶

DEEPER COGNITION ▲

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Evaluate			Principal	
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When NOT to reach for matrix-grid.

Pass/fail or delivery status

If cells mean shipped/at-risk/blocked, use `obligation-matrix` or `roadmap` — their semantic state palette (pass/warn/fail) is built for exactly that read, and matrix-grid's categorical row colors would mislead.

More than one filled cell per row

Each row names one position — one `[x]`. Multiple filled cells in a row breaks the "this is where you are" read; use `[-]` for the cells the row can still reach.

Unordered axes

The grid earns its shape when both axes have a real order (shallow → deep, narrow → wide). Two free categorical labels belong in `matrix-2x2`.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`obligation-matrix` — rows × columns of pass/partial/exempt status, not a single position

`roadmap` — phases × workstreams delivery status

`matrix-2x2` — two free axes, four cells, qualitative placement

`verdict-grid` — options scored against shared criteria, one card per option